Common Mistakes Sheet

Document ID: CF101-MISTAKES | Source: error log of the demo student S-0042 over the eight mock exams

Each row is one topic. 'Attempted' is the total number of questions on that topic seen across all mocks and practice sets; 'Missed' is how many were answered incorrectly. Times are the average seconds spent per question when the answer was right and when it was wrong. The exam time budget is 90 seconds per question.

Table 3 - Error log: Cloud Concepts

Topic	Attempted	Missed	Avg sec (right)	Avg sec (wrong)
Shared responsibility model	30	5	62	88
CapEx vs OpEx	20	2	55	70
Regions and region pairs	24	6	70	105

Table 3 - Error log: Compute & Networking

Topic	Attempted	Missed	Avg sec (right)	Avg sec (wrong)
VM scale sets and autoscale rules	34	12	84	126
Availability zones vs availability sets	32	9	76	110
VNet peering vs VPN gateway	44	21	92	138
Load balancer vs application gateway	38	19	88	141

Table 3 - Error log: Storage & Data

Topic	Attempted	Missed	Avg sec (right)	Avg sec (wrong)
Storage redundancy options	42	11	66	97
Access tiers and lifecycle rules	30	8	72	101
Database service selection	36	13	85	122

Table 3 - Error log: Security & Identity

Topic	Attempted	Missed	Avg sec (right)	Avg sec (wrong)
RBAC vs policies	48	31	98	152
Managed identities vs service principals	40	26	94	148
Network security rule priority	36	22	90	139
Key and secret management	30	14	82	118

Table 3 - Error log: Monitoring & Cost

Topic	Attempted	Missed	Avg sec (right)	Avg sec (wrong)
Metrics vs logs	34	15	78	115
Budgets vs cost alerts	28	10	74	108
Reservations vs savings plans	26	12	80	120

Why these mistakes happen

RBAC vs policies

Role-based access control decides WHO can do WHAT on a resource. A policy decides WHAT is allowed or required for resources regardless of who acts. Students mix them up because both appear in the same 'governance' menu. Rule of thumb: if the question names a person, group or application, think RBAC; if it names a rule about resource properties (region, size, tags), think policy.

Managed identities vs service principals

A managed identity is a service principal whose credentials are created and rotated automatically by the platform. A manually registered service principal needs secrets or certificates that you must rotate. If a question says 'no credentials to manage', the answer is a managed identity.

VNet peering vs VPN gateway

Peering connects two virtual networks over the provider backbone with low latency and no gateway. A VPN gateway encrypts traffic over the public internet and is used for on-premises connections. Peering is not transitive by default.

Load balancer vs application gateway

A load balancer works at layer 4 (TCP/UDP) and is chosen for raw throughput. An application gateway works at layer 7 (HTTP/HTTPS) and offers URL routing and a web application firewall.

Network security rule priority

Rules are evaluated from the lowest priority number to the highest, and processing stops at the first match. A rule with priority 100 beats a rule with priority 200.